**ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Y**
**LIMITED CITY CHARTER**

**VOTE NO on Measure Y.** Protect Benicia's future!

Measure Y is a **Trojan Horse** — designed to look "limited" while quietly opening the door to major changes in Benicia's government and tax structure. Benicia has been a general law city for 167 years. State law protects residents from sudden changes in government structure and certain tax increases. Measure Y would **strip away those protections.** Vallejo is a charter city. How's that working out for them?

In 2024, the City spent $233,000 promoting charter and transfer tax measures. Benicia voters rejected them decisively. But City Hall didn't listen. They're back again.

This year, the City is spending $288,000 on consultants and lobbying to sell these Measures, using a new tactic: the inaccurate claim that the charter would be "limited."

If Measure Y passes, the City can seek to expand the charter at any time. **Nothing in Measure Y prevents future changes**.

Measure Y would lift state limits on Benicia's government structure. The City could seek to change its form of government. That's the kind of thing that led to abuses that occurred in the City of Bell in the 2000s.

Benicia doesn't need a charter to capture revenue from new construction. Contamination at Valero's shuttered refinery is severe; cleanup will take **decades**. The "Seeno" project will likely never be built, once environmental studies are completed.

Voters should reject Measure Y. All three California cities that filed **bankruptcy** — San Bernardino, Stockton, and Vallejo — **were charter cities.** Charter cities can modify their charters to obtain exemptions from state laws. They have greater ability to raise taxes on businesses, homeowners, and residents.

Do you want waves of higher fees and taxes? Do you want surprise changes in governance structure? That is what Measure Y would allow.

**Vote NO on Measure Y.**

Association of Benicians Opposing Charter City and Real Property Transfer Tax Measures
s/ Christopher Shenfield, Attorney at Law and Chairperson
s/ Lawrence Morsen, Retired Water Utility Executive
s/ Kenneth Bocox, 40-Year Benicia Resident
s/ William J. Groves, Retired Title Insurance Executive
s/ Melinda A. Laudy, Principal Interior Designer

